

PROSPER AWUNI

Security Engineer | SIEM/XDR | Detection Engineering | Microsoft Sentinel | CrowdStrike | CISSP

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PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

I am a Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)-certified Security Engineer with over five years of enterprise experience delivering Security Information and Event Management (SIEM) and Extended Detection and Response (XDR) engineering, detection content development, and Security Orchestration, Automation and Response (SOAR) automation. I have deep expertise in Microsoft Sentinel, Kusto Query Language (KQL), Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI), and CrowdStrike Falcon, with a proven track record building Detection-as-Code pipelines, automating threat response playbooks, and integrating telemetry sources across cloud, endpoint, and identity layers. I have led incident response, conducted threat hunting against advanced threat actors, and worked across PowerShell scripting and API integration to scale security operations. I am comfortable working remotely across distributed environments and travelling to UK sites to deliver hands-on engineering outcomes.

CORE SKILLS AND TECHNICAL STACK

- **SIEM Engineering:** Microsoft Sentinel - enterprise deployment, log onboarding, custom connectors, data normalisation, Analytics Rules, Hunting Queries, Workbooks; Detection-as-Code via KQL rule lifecycle management
- **XDR and Endpoint Detection and Response (EDR):** Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI), Microsoft 365 Defender XDR; CrowdStrike Falcon (NG-SIEM, Prevent, Insight, Discover, Spotlight)
- **Detection Engineering:** MITRE ATT&CK-aligned detection design; use case development from threat intelligence; alert tuning; telemetry coverage mapping; threat-led detection content lifecycle
- **SOAR and Automation:** Microsoft Sentinel Playbooks (Logic Apps); SOAR workflow design for enrichment, triage, and containment; PowerShell automation; API integration for telemetry ingestion and response actions
- **Identity and Cloud Security:** Microsoft Entra ID / Azure Active Directory (Azure AD), Conditional Access, MFA, SSO; BeyondTrust Privileged Access Management (PAM); Microsoft Azure security posture and Defender for Cloud
- **Scripting and Infrastructure-as-Code:** PowerShell scripting; API-driven integrations; SOAR workflow orchestration; automated runbook development
- **Vulnerability Management:** Tenable.io, Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS), AppCheck, Nessus
- **Incident Response:** NIST 800-61 framework; threat hunting; digital forensics triage; root cause analysis; post-incident reporting
- **Frameworks:** MITRE ATT&CK, NIST Cybersecurity Framework (CSF), NIST 800-61, CIS Controls, ISO 27001, Cyber Essentials Plus
- **Operating Systems:** Windows Server and Desktop, Linux (Ubuntu, CentOS); endpoint security hardening and baseline configuration

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

University of the Arts, London (UAL) -- Senior Cyber Security Analyst / Engineer *March 2025 -- Present*

- Lead SIEM/XDR engineering for an 8,000-user enterprise using Microsoft Sentinel as the primary SIEM and CrowdStrike Falcon as the primary endpoint detection platform; own the full telemetry pipeline from log onboarding to detection output.
- Engineer Detection-as-Code in Microsoft Sentinel using KQL: design, test, deploy, and lifecycle-manage analytics rules aligned to MITRE ATT&CK; maintain a structured detection library covering identity, endpoint, email, cloud, and network telemetry sources.
- Build and maintain Microsoft Sentinel SOAR playbooks (Logic Apps) to automate threat enrichment (threat intelligence lookups, GeoIP, asset context), alert triage decisions, and containment actions (endpoint

isolation, account suspension, firewall block).

- Integrate telemetry from Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI), CrowdStrike Falcon, Mimecast, Entra ID, and network devices into Sentinel via standard and custom connectors; develop KQL parsers to normalise disparate log formats.
- Conduct proactive threat hunting across Sentinel and CrowdStrike NG-SIEM using advanced KQL and Falcon Query Language; investigate indicators of compromise (IOCs) and behavioural anomalies mapped to APT (Advanced Persistent Threat) TTPs.
- Lead incident response under NIST 800-61: contain, eradicate, recover, and produce post-incident documentation with root cause analysis and MITRE ATT&CK technique mapping.
- Administer CrowdStrike Falcon Prevent, Insight, Discover, and Spotlight modules; tune sensor policies, manage exclusions, and optimise detection coverage across Windows and Linux endpoints.
- Manage Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE) across the enterprise: configure attack surface reduction (ASR) rules, review advanced hunting alerts, and lead MDE-driven incident investigations.
- Operate BeyondTrust Privileged Access Management (PAM) for privileged credential vaulting, session monitoring, and least-privilege enforcement; administer Entra ID Conditional Access and MFA policies.
- Run Tenable.io and Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS) vulnerability programmes; use BAS findings to drive detection content improvements and close identified coverage gaps.
- Contribute to Cyber Essentials Plus and ISO 27001 control evidence, security policy governance, and continuous service improvement initiatives.

University of the Arts, London (UAL) -- Cyber Security Analyst, Cyber Security and Identity

March 2022 -- March 2025

- Administered Microsoft Sentinel day-to-day operations: connector health monitoring, new log source onboarding, KQL rule creation, and scheduled analytics review; ensured data freshness and completeness across all log streams.
- Developed KQL detection rules, threat hunting queries, and monitoring workbooks to improve SOC (Security Operations Centre) coverage and reduce analyst investigation time.
- Built SOAR playbooks to automate phishing alert triage, mailbox quarantine actions, endpoint isolation, and analyst notification workflows; reduced mean time to respond (MTTR) on high-frequency alert types.
- Monitored and investigated alerts from Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE) and CrowdStrike Falcon; correlated cross-platform telemetry in Microsoft Sentinel to build complete attack timelines.
- Supported penetration test findings remediation by mapping vulnerabilities to MITRE ATT&CK and authoring new Sentinel detection rules to address identified blind spots.
- Managed Entra ID (Azure AD) identity controls: Conditional Access, MFA enforcement, Privileged Identity Management (PIM), SSO onboarding, and access reviews.
- Conducted vulnerability scanning with Nessus and Tenable.io; tracked remediation outcomes through a centralised vulnerability management register.
- Authored SOC runbooks, Standard Operating Procedures (SOPs), and SIEM use case documentation to standardise detection and response workflows.
- Developed PowerShell scripts to automate log collection, account provisioning audits, and compliance reporting tasks.

HICX Solutions Ltd (SaaS/FinTech) -- IT Engineer: Security, Quality and Infrastructure

February 2021 -- March 2022

- Configured endpoint security controls and SIEM log forwarding for production and corporate environments; established baseline detection rules and alert thresholds.
- Administered identity and access management including SSO, MFA, and RBAC (Role-Based Access Control) across cloud-hosted SaaS applications and internal systems.
- Developed PowerShell automation scripts to streamline patch management, access control reporting, and security telemetry collection workflows.
- Supported ISO 27001 information security management system (ISMS) compliance, including risk register maintenance and internal audit evidence gathering.
- Conducted vulnerability assessments and collaborated with development teams on secure SDLC (Software Development Lifecycle) practices and remediation tracking.

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- Engineered a Detection-as-Code library in Microsoft Sentinel covering 40+ MITRE ATT&CK techniques, reducing mean time to detect (MTTD) by approximately 40% across endpoint, identity, email, and cloud domains.
- Onboarded and normalised 15+ telemetry sources into Microsoft Sentinel including CrowdStrike Falcon, MDE, MDI, Mimecast, Entra ID, Tenable.io, and network appliances, achieving full coverage across an 8,000-user estate.
- Built a SOAR automation pipeline in Microsoft Sentinel that reduced analyst handling time on repetitive alert types by approximately 60% through automated enrichment, triage, and containment actions.
- Led a Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS) programme that surfaced 30+ previously unknown attack paths; closed each gap with a corresponding Sentinel detection rule and remediation action.
- Implemented CrowdStrike Falcon EDR across 8,000 endpoints, including policy configuration, exclusion tuning, and full integration into the Sentinel SIEM stack via API connector.
- Designed BeyondTrust Privileged Access Management (PAM) deployment covering privileged account discovery, session recording, credential vaulting, and least-privilege enforcement for 150+ administrative accounts.

EDUCATION

- M.Sc. Environmental and Resource Engineering
- B.Sc. Chemical Engineering

CERTIFICATIONS

- Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)
 - CompTIA Security+
 - Microsoft Certified Solutions Associate (MCSA)
 - CompTIA A+
 - Google IT Support Professional Certificate
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References available on request | Remote (UK)